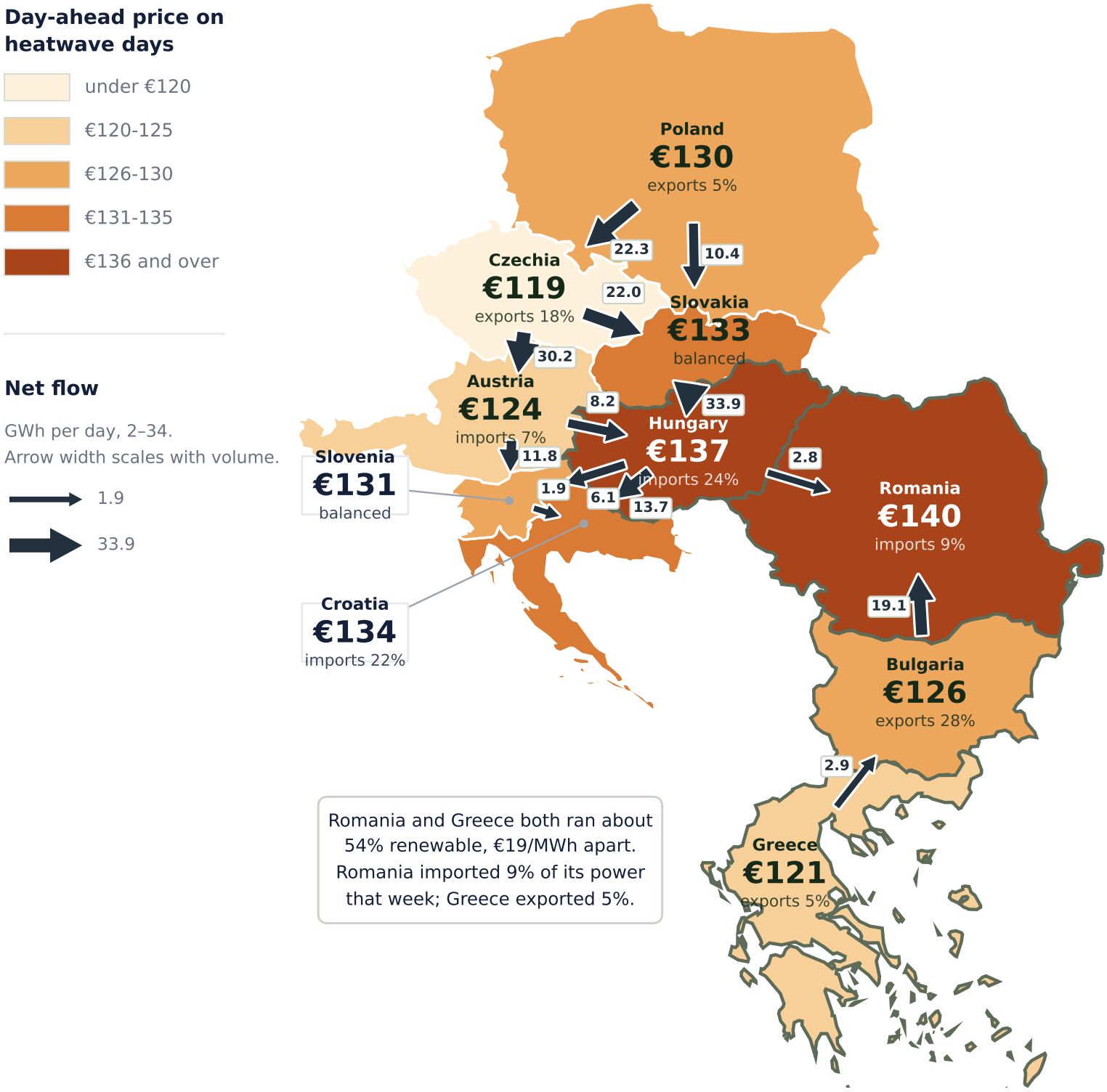
Power flowed out of the cheap markets and into the dear ones

Net trade, day-ahead price and net cross-border flow on heatwave days, May–September 2026.
Across these ten, price tracks net trade (r = +0.67), not renewable share (r = +0.03). Neither causes the other: a country imports because it is short, and being short is what costs.
Arrows are net flow, scaled by volume; power ran to the dearer market on 10 of 13 borders.



Net trade is the balance of physical cross-border flows over the country's own demand. Arrows are the mean net flow across each border on days when either end was in a heatwave; every border is collapsed to one direction first, since ENTSO-E reports each one twice. All of each country's interconnectors are included, the Balkan and non-EU borders among them. A heatwave day is 3+ consecutive days above the local day-of-year 90th percentile of daily maximum temperature, or at or above 30 ·C, against the same country's non-heatwave days in the same season, weekday to weekday. Price is the unweighted daily mean of day-ahead prices. Source: ENTSO-E Transparency Platform; ERA5 via Open-Meteo.